Genesis 1-2: Dr. Crawford Loritts Part 1 - Session 10 - 09/08/202

We underplay the book of Genesis. There is a hermeneutic principle called the law of first mention: a Bible study principle that says the first time a word, topic, or concept is introduced in Scripture sets the foundational meaning for how it should be understood throughout the Bible.

For example the first time the word worship is used was when Abraham is going to offer up his son Isaac.

Worship has to do with self denial.

Hermeneutic principle: Hermeneutic -> relating to interpretation, specifically of scripture. Principle -> a rule, guidelines, or foundational truth.

What we feel about a passage, what we like for it to say, what we don't like about it is categorically irrelevant. To many of us, especially churches, pride ourselves in teaching the scriptures. One of the things we will deal with through the rest of our Christian lives is the tension between using the bible as a point of reference or embracing it as the context for your life and thinking. You've got to decide early on that the bible is going to be the context of your life and thinking. It is going to supreme and how you feel isn't going to make a difference. It should modify how we think. It should contextualize your life. You should not contextualize the scriptures. It is objective. It is the voice of God.

We get too casual and think it's up to us to assign meaning to a passage. No it's up to us to submit to the clear meaning of the passage.

Hermeneutic approach - a literal, grammatical, historical interpretation of the scriptures.

When referring to the literal aspect: We don't have the right to superimpose our feelings into the scripture. In other words God doesn't have a speech impediment.
When we refer to the grammatical aspect: words matter. Words are important. Their god breathed.

When we refer to the historical aspect: We mean the contextual things that are happening. What is going on? Why did Paul say what he said that way? What is happening around the setting here.

The late Howard Henry (Aka Carl F. H. Henry was an American Evangelical theologian in the 20th century. He was born January 22nd, 1913 on Long Island, New York. Died December 7th 2003). He used to say: the bible was not given to satisfy our curiosity, but was to transform our lives.

"The dastardly assumption is that because we know a lot, and we are right about what we know, that knowledge has transformed us. I would remind you that The Pharisees were excellent Bible scholars." - What a banger from Dr. Loritts

There are some evangelicals who believe the events that happened between Genesis 1 and 2 happened over thousands of years. Dr. Loritts doesn't buy this. This would mean those individuals don't hold the Hermeneutic view that this is a literal representation of what happened in a 7 day period. He doesn't buy that because of the normative language of the passage.

1. What "normative" means in theology/ethics

When scholars or pastors say "normative language," they're talking about **language that sets norms, standards, or ideals** — basically how things *should be* rather than just how they *are.*

- **Descriptive language** = "This is what happened."
- **Normative language** = "This is the pattern God set; this is how life is meant to be ordered."

2. Applying that to Genesis 1–2

If someone says Genesis 1–2 contains "normative language," they mean:

- The creation account isn't just a story about beginnings.
- It's laying down **God's intended design** for humanity, relationships, work, rest, marriage, and creation itself.
- For example:
    - Humanity is made in God's image → **norm for human dignity and equality**.
    - God rests on the seventh day → **norm for Sabbath/rest rhythms**.
    - God creates male and female, brings them together as "one flesh" → **norm for marriage**.

3. Why this matters

The argument is that Genesis 1–2 is not merely history (what happened), but also **foundational theology (what should guide us now)**. Many Christian positions on gender, marriage, sexuality, stewardship of the earth, and even work-rest balance lean on the claim that these passages are *normative.*

Dr. Loritts says -> "There is no reason to conclude that this is just allegory or image."

Why would it be hard to believe that God created a grown mature earth when it's clear that God created a grown and mature Adam and Eve.

“In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth.”
Genesis 1:1 ESV

“The earth was without form and void, and darkness was over the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God was hovering over the face of the waters.”
Genesis 1:2 ESV

There is a theory called the The **Gap Theory** (sometimes called the *Gap Restoration Theory* or *Ruin-Restoration Theory*) is a particular way of interpreting the opening verses of **Genesis**. Here’s the breakdown:

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1. Basic Idea

- Genesis 1:1 → *“In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth.”*
- Genesis 1:2 → *“And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep…”*

The **Gap Theory** suggests that between **verse 1** and **verse 2** there is a *gap* of possibly billions of years.

- Verse 1 = God originally created a perfect heavens and earth.
- Something catastrophic happened (often explained as Satan’s fall, rebellion, or judgment).
- Verse 2 = The earth became “formless and void” (Hebrew: *tohu va-bohu*).
- The rest of Genesis 1 describes not the original creation, but God **restoring** or **reordering** the earth.

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2. Why People Proposed It

- In the 19th and 20th centuries, Christians tried to reconcile the Bible with geological and fossil evidence suggesting an ancient earth.
- The Gap Theory allowed for:
    - A very old earth (fitting with geological ages).
    - A relatively recent “restoration” (the six days of Genesis).

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3. Key Features of the Theory

- The fall of Satan and the angels is placed in this gap.
- Fossil records and extinct creatures (like dinosaurs) are explained as belonging to the pre-Adamic world.

- The six days in Genesis are seen not as original creation but as **re-creation / restoration**.

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4. Criticisms

- Many theologians argue the Hebrew text doesn't require reading "was without form" as "became without form."
- It can be seen as importing modern science into the text rather than drawing from the text itself.
- Young-earth creationists reject it, preferring a literal six-day creation ~6,000–10,000 years ago.
- Old-earth creationists and theistic evolutionists see other models (like day-age or framework views) as stronger.

✅ **In short:**
The **Gap Restoration Theory** teaches that God first created the world (Gen. 1:1), it later fell into chaos (possibly through Satan's rebellion), and then God restored it in six days (Gen. 1:2 onward). It's an attempt to reconcile the Bible's creation account with geological evidence of an old earth.

Another theory is that there is some kind of destruction that took place during Genesis 1:1. And somehow this is the time when Satan fell from heaven. This is exactly why you have to be careful with speculation.

We don't know what Genesis 1:1 implies more so than what it says. So you don't want to interject speculation. We don't know when Satan fell.

We know there to be six days of creation
Day 1:

"And God said, "Let there be light," and there was light. And God saw that the light was good. And God separated the light from the darkness. God called the light Day, and the darkness he called Night. And there was evening and there was morning, the first day."
Genesis 1:3-5 ESV

Day 2:

"And God said, "Let there be an expanse in the midst of the waters, and let it separate the waters from the waters." And God made the expanse and separated the waters that were under the expanse from the waters that were above the expanse. And it was so. And God called the expanse Heaven. And there was evening and there was morning, the second day."

Genesis 1:6-8 ESV

Day 3:

“And God said, “Let the waters under the heavens be gathered together into one place, and let the dry land appear.” And it was so. God called the dry land Earth, and the waters that were gathered together he called Seas. And God saw that it was good. And God said, “Let the earth sprout vegetation, plants yielding seed, and fruit trees bearing fruit in which is their seed, each according to its kind, on the earth.” And it was so. The earth brought forth vegetation, plants yielding seed according to their own kinds, and trees bearing fruit in which is their seed, each according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. And there was evening and there was morning, the third day.”

Genesis 1:9-13 ESV

Day 4:

“And God said, “Let there be lights in the expanse of the heavens to separate the day from the night. And let them be for signs and for seasons, and for days and years, and let them be lights in the expanse of the heavens to give light upon the earth.” And it was so. And God made the two great lights—the greater light to rule the day and the lesser light to rule the night—and the stars. And God set them in the expanse of the heavens to give light on the earth, to rule over the day and over the night, and to separate the light from the darkness. And God saw that it was good. And there was evening and there was morning, the fourth day.”

Genesis 1:14-19 ESV

Day 5:

“And God said, “Let the waters swarm with swarms of living creatures, and let birds fly above the earth across the expanse of the heavens.” So God created the great sea creatures and every living creature that moves, with which the waters swarm, according to their kinds, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. And God blessed them, saying, “Be fruitful and multiply and fill the waters in the seas, and let birds multiply on the earth.” And there was evening and there was morning, the fifth day.”

Genesis 1:20-23 ESV

Day 6:

“And God said, “Let the earth bring forth living creatures according to their kinds—livestock and creeping things and beasts of the earth according to their kinds.” And it was so. And God made the beasts of the earth according to their kinds and the livestock according to their kinds, and everything that creeps on the ground according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. Then God said, “Let us make man in our image, after our likeness. And let them have dominion over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the heavens and over the livestock and over all the

earth and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth." So God created man in his own image, in the image of God he created him; male and female he created them."
Genesis 1:24-27 ESV (Also Psalm 8 -> What is man that you're mindful of him).

To be depraved is not the eradication of dignity:

1. What "depraved" means

In theology (especially Reformed thought), *depravity* refers to the condition of humanity after the Fall:

- Sin has corrupted our desires, motives, and actions.
- We cannot, by ourselves, live in perfect righteousness or reach God's standard of holiness.
- This is often called *total depravity* (though not meaning "utter depravity" where we are as bad as possible, but that sin touches every part of us).

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2. What "dignity" means

Biblically, *dignity* comes from being made in the **image of God** (Genesis 1:26–27).

- Every person, regardless of sin, still carries the **imago Dei** (God's image).
- That gives inherent worth, value, and dignity that cannot be erased.

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3. So what the phrase means

"To be depraved is not the eradication of dignity" =

Even though humanity is fallen and sinful (depraved), this does not mean:

- That the **image of God is destroyed.** It is marred, distorted, corrupted, but still present.
- That humans lose all **value or worth.** God still sees human life as valuable (hence redemption, Christ's incarnation, moral responsibility).
- That sin cancels our capacity to reflect God in some ways. We still have creativity, conscience, love, reasoning, etc.—though imperfectly.

The creation is an expression of God's authority. At the beginning of the bible God declares and showcases his authority. God created everything by speaking it into existence.

There is a latin expression called ex nihilo meaning: **out of nothing God created.**

Often when trying to help people understand theological concepts from the bible we dilute them a little too much.

In fact God does not define what he means by image. God doesn't define what he means by likeness. Certainly it implies ownership. Certainly it applies supernatural branding. It implies certain communicative shared attributes. It implies dignity and value but pathetically in this polarizing society and culture we are living in right now be very careful of letting your hostility and anger cross the line. If you're listening to any politician or any talking head on your news channel that makes you feel good about loving people less, turn them off. That's a violation of the dignity and image of God.

At the end of his creation God declared everything was very good and he rested. Aka the sabbath. The Hebrew word is Shabbat: to cease, to stop, to rest.

Little side note here, stop bragging about being a workaholic" -Dr. Loritts.

"When you say that it's nothing more than Idolatry." That's an expression of having control issues. It can also be an expression of low self esteem. Needing approval of people based on your performance. The inability to rest means that we don't trust God. Ouch.

God doesn't need rest or run out of energy but he rested. God's showing us "Hey Bryce, you're not the fourth member of the trinity buddy."

Dr. Loritts used to hear people say, "I'd rather burn out of Jesus than rest out of Jesus." Loritt said he used to quote that and then one day it dawned on him "That's a stupid statement." Why is it stupid? Because out is out and you shouldn't want to be "out." You should want to have the energy to run to the finish line. Where do you get that from? From rest, and reflection and health. God does not want healthy children. Hebrews 4. Operate from refreshment. Stop feeling guilty because you do something you love. You play golf or something that is energizing. Rest.

Summary of Genesis Chapter 2:

Adam being called to tend the garden of Edan authenticates for man that "work is not a curse." We were created to be productive. To take dominion is the rejection of passivity. This is before the fall. Genesis 2 tells us that we are called to take care of and not abuse what feeds us. Which is why we need to be careful to not go too far into another political party's direction but we are called to not take care of it either.

I'm not a **Egalitarian** I'm a **Complementarian:**

Egalitarian comes from the French word *égal* ("equal") and the Latin *aequalis* ("equal").

General meaning

An **egalitarian** is someone who believes in or advocates for **equality**—that all people should have the same rights, opportunities, and value, without discrimination based on gender, race, class, or other differences.

In theology/church context

When Christians use the term "egalitarian," it often refers to a particular belief about **gender roles**:

- **Egalitarianism** teaches that men and women are equal not only in worth before God but also in **roles and responsibilities**.
- This view says women and men can both serve in leadership, preach, teach, and hold any role in the church or home, based on gifting rather than gender.
- It contrasts with **complementarianism**, which holds that men and women are equal in worth but have distinct, complementary roles (e.g., male leadership in church and home).

👉 In short: **Egalitarianism = equality in value and roles.**
Not just "all are equal in dignity," but also "all are equally eligible for leadership and responsibility."

Let's unpack **complementarian**:

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1. General meaning

- From *complement* → "to complete or balance."
- **Complementarianism** teaches that men and women are **equal in value and dignity before God**, but have **different, complementary roles** in the home, church, and sometimes society.

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2. Key theological points

- **Equality in worth** → both men and women are made in the *image of God* (Genesis 1:27).

- **Distinction in roles** → men are typically understood to have the role of spiritual headship/leadership, while women are seen as called to support, nurture, and serve in ways that complement male leadership.
- **Biblical basis cited** → passages like:
    - *Ephesians 5:22–33* → husbands as heads of the home, wives submitting as the church does to Christ.
    - *1 Timothy 2:11–14* → restrictions on women teaching or exercising authority over men in the gathered church.
    - *1 Corinthians 11 and 14* → patterns of order in worship.

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3. Contrast with Egalitarianism

- **Egalitarianism** = equal value **and** equal opportunity for roles.
- **Complementarianism** = equal value, but distinct roles based on gender.

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4. Practical outworking

- In **marriage** → husband leads sacrificially, wife submits respectfully.
- In the **church** → men serve as pastors/elders, women serve in other capacities but not in governing/teaching authority over men (depending on interpretation).

👉 **In short:**
A **complementarian** believes men and women are equally valuable before God, but He designed them to fulfill **different, complementary roles** in marriage and church life.

Complementarian: It's a view that there is male headship Ephesians Chapter 5 and through the scriptures. There is a separation of roles. But that doesn't mean your wife is inferior to me. In fact, a woman's strengths are incredible. We are partners. The desire to dominate one another or put down one another is a product of sin but not creation.

Adam was born with a need and to be married means two people that were needy.

Theological Tensions (Part 2) - Dr. Cole Huffman

In the book "finding the right hill to die on" the author quotes another author that gives 8 points on how to know how to rank doctrine.

1. **Biblical clarity - how clear is the doctrine**
2. **Relevance to the character of God**

3. **Relevance to the essence of the Gospel - meaning "how do I get right with God."**
4. **Biblical frequency and significance - when reading the bible you're looking for things that are repeated. Same for doctrine. How much "weight" does scripture put on this specific subject?**
5. **The effect on other doctrines - Some doctrines are like a tree trunk where others might be the branches.**
6. **Consensus among Christians - Past and Present.**
7. **Effect on personal and church life**
8. **Current cultural pressure to deny a teaching of the scripture - so you'll know a certain emphasis on certain doctrines is key because it becomes a tension point with the wider culture that Christians should give ground.**

Since entire volumes have been written on the four ranks we can't go into complete detail in an hour and so therefore will give you flavor.

Starting with Rank 1 an example would be "grace has to be grace." Grace has to be unmarried unearned favor. It can't be earned or worked for.

"For by grace you have been saved through faith. And this is not your own doing; it is the gift of God, not a result of works, so that no one may boast."
Ephesians 2:8-9 ESV

If you could "earn grace" you could boast but since we can't earn grace boasting is taken away.

Here is another first ranked doctrine. **The triune nature of God** (The triune nature of God is a Christian doctrine stating that God is one being in three co-equal, co-eternal persons: the Father, the Son (Jesus Christ), and the Holy Spirit.)

Trinitarianism is important because it accounts for how the scriptures in both the new and old testament can dogmatically assert that there is only one God and yet the father, son and spirit, are each presented as divine. So trinitarian doctrine is meant to safeguard us from the understanding of God's nature and personality that's oversimplified. Like we said earlier if your God has no mystery then it's a God of your own making. If you oversimply the Character and personality of God then you deny his majesty.

A Jehovah's witness is a great example of this. They have their own translation. If you learn their doctrine you'll see they take passages like colossians 1 and john 1 and they change it and add things that aren't there. Why? It's because their theology is a very simplified Jehovah. The trinitary doctrine is meant to confuse us. It's a ploy to get us

all complicated and complex about God. But they give up the mystery of God to have this overly simple view of God.

So here is where we get more complex:

There can be differences in nuanced understanding among those that hold the same first rank doctrine.

So among trinitarians for example there is a debate over whether Jesus has been subordinate to God the Father for all eternity or just within the limits of his incarnation. Proving that where you land on that topic is secondary to the first rank doctrine of God being a trinity; one what three whose one being three persons.

Another first ranked doctrine: Justification by faith. Justification meaning being declared righteous by God. Evangelical first ranked doctrine is that it's essential to understand how the gospel works that we emphasize justification by faith because this communicates how we are accepted by God. How are we made right by God? The reformation covered this understanding which is why we honor the reformation. Justified means Jesus's righteousness (he who had no sin but was treated on the cross as if he were guilty of every kind of sin) gets applied to me, which is the basis of my acceptance and approval by God. Justification means declared righteous by grace. Which is one of those "tree trunk" doctrines with a lot of branches moving off it. Jesus's marit is the key thing. Not my own. He makes me righteous before God. I don't earn that. I'm not as good as Jesus.

Other first ranked doctrines: The necessity of Jesus's cross. Backed by what Paul said to the Corinthians. " I know nothing among you except Chris and him being crucified."

And in a chapter before that Paul calls the gospel "the word of the cross."

Another first rank doctrine: Jesus substituting himself in our place. The doctrine of substitutionary atonement. You'll find people get squirrelly with that one but it's a core cornerstone doctrine.

Another first rank doctrine: "the new birth" You must be born again. It's more than just a transaction. It's the beginning point which is the point of which you believe (that's justification) and then you move through sanctification (the action of making or declaring something holy) your life in Christ growing and learning set apart. And then

we are glorified some fine day when we awaken and we put on our resurrection bodies. You will be new-bodied. It's not some spiritual ethereal wispy on a cloud experience.

Another first ranked doctrine: the bodily resurrection of Jesus. That he rose bodily is key. That's core. That's so core that we are told that if anyone ever asks you, " hey is there something that would cause you to no longer be a Christian?" You can take that person to 1 Corinthians 15 and point out that it says if the resurrection didn't happen our faith is worthless. It's not even beneficial for moral formation because it's built on a lie.

Now we discuss 2nd rank doctrine which is where we see theological tensions get tense. This is where you'll see a lot of people that hold the same first rank doctrine start to separate which is why you get denominational differences etc.

The first example of 2nd ranked doctrine would be baptism. And again we know we aren't saying somehow baptism is "less" but here is why it's second rank.

There is the baptism of the spirit in scripture.

There is baptism by water in scripture.

That's not a theological binary - there is both.

When Paul writes in Ephesians 4: 4

"There is one body and one Spirit—just as you were called to the one hope that belongs to your call—" "one Lord, one faith, one baptism,"
Ephesians 4:4-5 ESV

When Paul says that he's talking about baptism in the spirit. Baptism of the spirit takes place when we are redeemed. How you go downstream from that would be rank 3 doctrine on the different avenues people take. But we know that baptism of the spirit is a thing.

So now we get to water baptism - some believe water baptism belongs in the "core" rank 1. As an example that would be the Church of Christ, who believe that you are not forgiven, you have not had the blood of Christ cover you until the waters of baptism cover you. And that's why historically the church of christ as not been considered evangelical because they have an understanding of baptism that is out of step with "by

grace alone" "by faith alone." To say water baptism is essential for grace would indicate that it's turning into a work. Something you have to do. In order for forgiveness to take.

Dr. Cole Huffman - who comes from a baptist church - says that as his church they say baptism by water isn't essential but neither is it optional. Their church is conveying it in attention. Meaning you don't have to be baptized to be a Christian but you should be baptized if you are a Christian. There is no reason not to be. The very name of "baptist" means we believe in something significant about baptism.

Now a further wrinkle: Not all Christians want to baptize in the same way.

How did this come about? Well you'd have to go back through church history where we start by looking at the mode of baptism. Some people put the person under water. Then there is baptism by affusion which is just pouring. Then there is baptism by taking water and just sprinkling it on someone. Mode is a tension point. But it's a tension point among people who tend to believe the same first rank things.

Now he asks how many people were baptized as an infinite. Dr. Cole Huffman says he was. His parents were comulen presbyterian I believe he says.

The technical term for that is Paedobaptism: the practice of baptizing infant children of believers, which is a tradition in some denominations like the Catholic, Orthodox, and some Protestant churches.

In Catholic theology grace accumulates to you as you participate in the means the church provides you to get grace. There is no assurance of salvation. You've got to be a good catholic. And where that starts is your parents are "good catholics" hopefully and they take you to be christened which is called infinite justification. It's your first taste of Grace and then you're going to go through the process the church tells you to stay current with and all the way to final rights.

That's not the protestant understanding of infinite baptism. If protestant theology emphasizes covenant theology parents present their children for infinite baptism as a covenant act. And that covenant act is a recognition that God makes covenants throughout scripture - which is a hermeneutic - and baptism is taken as the sign of the seal of God bringing people through families into a covenant. So if you're born into a home with believing parents the children are in a covenant family. It doesn't make the

child a Christian but the baptism signifies the child is in a Christian home and the child will be led to Christ in that home.

Opposite of that is Credobaptism, or [believer's baptism](), is the practice of baptizing individuals who have made a personal profession of faith in Jesus Christ

This was crazy fought over in the 1500s. People were getting killed. Believers killing believers over mode of baptism.

Again baptists put a water baptism in a second rank category. It's important to the life and health of their church. Meaning I don't teach counsel or speak against credobaptism.

"For Christ did not send me to baptize but to preach the gospel, and not with words of eloquent wisdom, lest the cross of Christ be emptied of its power."
1 Corinthians 1:17 ESV

Why would Paul say thee above if Baptism was essential?

When you get baptized that's when you get marked and that's when you've stepped out in true Christian confession at which persecution starts for a lot of people.

Spiritual gifts is another second rank theological. Specifically the application of the miraculous gifts like speaking in tongues or healing.

Spiritual gifts are listed:
1 Corinthians 12
Romans 12
Ephesians 4

Peter talks about spiritual gifts as God given abilities. To glorify him and edify one another in the church. 1 Peter 4

If you are a sensationalist, you believe spiritual gifts died with the last apostle. Once the New Testament is complete there's no longer a need for miraculous signs or gifts. Just like a steam roller is there for laying the pavement, but once the pavement is flat and layed, you no longer need a steamroller.

A continuationist on the other hand believes that all spiritual gifts including the miraculous sign gifts, like healing and tongues still exist.

Then to further complicate things you've got hard and soft versions of each. Like a hard continuationist would say that the whole spirit must accompany the ability to speak in tongues or speaking in tongues must accompany the baptism of the spirit otherwise something is wrong with your spiritual life. Whereas a soft continuationist would say it needs be there. We encourage it to be there but if it's not there we aren't going to act like it is or force it.

Then we move on to gender roles as a second rank doctrine. Which is a big one

The camps here go by the names Complementarian and egalitarian.

Complementarians believe men and women equally convey the image of God and are equally valuable to God, but are not functionally equal in the church as to role.

Complementarians believe male and female roles were set at creation. Before sin enters the picture. You've got Adam in a leadership role responsible for naming everything before Eve. And that because of that it means something. The fall into sin defaced this perspective but it did not erase it.

Egalitarians start off the same as complementarians where they both believe men and women equally convey the image of God and are equally valuable to God. But then Egalitarians believe the other road and say male and female are functionally equal also. Or should be. As to their role in the church and family. Egalitarians believe gender roles are a result of the fall.

The main discrepancy between the two is not about the image of male and female in God but the issue is whether gender roles are culturally conditioned, or conditioned to by creation.

And just like everything else there is a hard and soft continuation. You've got hard complementarians and soft complementarians for example.

If you're going to biblically study this you'd want to go back to the creation narrative through Genesis. You're going to look at Paul's writings. 1 Corinthians 11, 14. Galatians 3. The offices of the church in 1st Timothy 2 and 3 and then the household instruction which is in Titus 2. You're going to want to look at how Jesus included

women in his ministry. A very radical thing for him to do in his day. You're going to want to look at the family instructions within Ephesians 5 and Collosians 3. Then there is also authentication through church history. How have our forefathers understood gender roles in their cultural contexts?

An idea can not be held responsible for those who claim to believe in it. Meaning an idea can still be good even if the people who believe in it are not good.

The speaker says he tells people he's complementarian because he believes that's what the scriptures teach but he's not patriarchal. Basically you can plop him on the soft side of the complementarian spectrum.

Basically when I say I don't want to be patriarchal is that I don't want to be a theo bro who thinks God is annoyed with women. There's enough of that going around.

When you respect biblical authority it does not mean you can't ask probing questions of the bible or have struggles with what the Bible teaches or have doubts. Just be sure you're not using your struggles or doubts as permission to indulge your sinful nature. Biblical authority means you let the bible have the final say as best I can understand it.

One good test of orthodoxy is can I accept that received truth from God will place some restrictions on me. At some point some way somehow. Some doctrines are still true even if I don't like them or want them to be true. Does anyone want the doctrine of hell to be true? No. Who was the biggest proponent to hell in the bible? Jesus Christ. He talked about it more than anyone. But what I have to square with when I look at hell in the bible is that I'm not more merciful than God. If I reject hell because I don't like it then I'm basically saying "God I think I'm more merciful than you." So I want to worship God by way of what I've revealed. Not what I emotionally prefer. And there might be things I emotionally prefer but their not keeping in line with what God revealed. The God I worship can contradict me. If I've got a God who can't contradict me and can't correct me then I've got a God of my own making. Also known as an Idol.

The old French skeptic Voltare, " God made man in his imagine and man has forever been trying to return the compliment." We want to remake God after ourselves. It's been a temptation for a long time. Be wary of oversimplification. Be wary of overreach and overthinking. Be wary of pigeonholing and lumping.

“But we have renounced disgraceful, underhanded ways. We refuse to practice cunning or to tamper with God’s word, but by the open statement of the truth we would commend ourselves to everyone’s conscience in the sight of God.”
2 Corinthians 4:2 ESV

GK Chesterton (**was an English author, philosopher, Christian apologist, poet, journalist and magazine editor)** **wrote 100 years ago, “ Idolity is not merely created by setting up false Gods but also by setting up false devils.”**

When we do that and we make ourselves or our tribe the judge of what’s edifying and not we shrink the kingdom of God down to our own size and the kingdom is bigger than us. It is bigger than our tribes. God loves people you disagree with. God blesses people and churches whose theology you can not abide by. God pleases people who see it differently than you or I do. God loves and blesses the guy who thanked God for earning some grace in his prayer. Every theological position that we take stands or falls before a creator who judges the intentions of our heart with absolute charity. What we are after in respecting theological tension is humility. Humility is largely about how you use power. Do you use power in service to others or do you use it to lord? Humility means lowering oneself from a height. One of the radical things about Jesus is that he led humility. Nobody was doing that. When he said “I’m gentle and humble in heart” during Matthew 11 do you know how staggeringly strange that was? Everyone lorded over each other with power but Jesus said, “I’m not like that.”

Third rank doctrine would be eschatology. Aka the doctrine of the end times. It’s not unimportant. It’s important but it’s also the future and we haven’t lived the future yet. And while we can take a viewpoint the main thing to remember is that we can say “Christ is returning” which is a core doctrine.

Another one would be “the age of the earth.”

Affirming creation is first rank but it is fundamentalism to say, you’re in the ditch if you say, if you don’t believe the earth is young you don’t believe in Genesis.

You actually have three things to consider when thinking about this. 1. The age of the universe. 2. The age of the earth and 3. The age of people. Those three things aren’t the same.

Dr. Cole Huffman's opinion is that age of the earth conversations are overreacting to Darwinian naturalism. And they are overreacting in such a way that it becomes whether you believe in Genesis or not.

Fourth rank doctrine examples would consist of whether believers drink alcohol or not. That's a matter of liberty. We are told not to get drunk. We are not told that we can't have a drink.

School choice whether that be home, public, or private.

Political allegiance

Theology of physical exercise or herbal supplements to ward off cancer.

To say these are unimportant doesn't mean that we are saying they aren't unimportant to you but that we do not build a church on these things. They are temporal. They are passing away. Our welcome of people is not by checking for political allegiance at the door.

Make it a priority to practice differentiation which is the ability to listen to something you disagree with and the emotional does not start churning.

"Show me somebody who's always trying to argue his way assert his practice, make his point his points more right more true than yours I'll show you somebody whose actually insecure."

"The need to win arguments is just unworthy of us in Christ."

Dana C Ortlund who wrote gentle and lowly the heart of Christ for sinners and sufferers concludes his book with a prayer, " Lord, where we have sinned either by failing to love the truth or failing to love our brothers and sisters in our disagreements about the truth forgive us and help us for those of us who tend to fight too much over theology help us remember that you also died for the unity of the church, your precious bride, give us softer hearts for those of us who tend to fight too little over theology help us to feel our need for courage and resilience. Give us stronger backbones help us to be people who tremble at your word, and therefore ultimately fear no one but you lead us toward that healthy happy balance of adhering to all your teaching, while embracing all your people. Amen."

Intro to Manhood/Womanhood Part 1 Dr. Cole Huffman:

Dr. Cole began by reminding us of our October discussion

He reintroduced the two terms:

1. **Complementarian**
2. **Egalitarian**

From the complementarian camp there is a book called " recovering biblical manhood and womanhood."

From the Egalitarian camp there is a book called," recovering from biblical manhood and womanhood.

So what do the two camps have in common?

1. Both believe that men and women equally bare God's image

A. Referencing Genesis 5:2 "male and female" he made them in his image

B. Both groups believe in the equality of dignity and value. Both are equally valued by God.

Where they differ:

1. Complementarians - Male and female roles are different
    A. There are gender roles that were set in the beginning - before the Genesis 3 fall

2. Egalitarians - believe gender roles are a result of the fall

A. Gender roles are sourced in Genesis 3

B. Men and women are alien to each other

C. Male headship is a post fall wrong that gets righted by Christ because Christ equally redeems. Equally fills us with the spirit. Equally gifts us. Equally calls us to ministry.

So tonight we will hit on three specific points:

1. **Gender at creation**

A. Is there a creational pattern?

B. **Do you see a pattern within Genesis 1 and 2**

2. Gender in church and household - tonight because of the verses we will be touching on will highlight more of the church side of things.

3. Contemporary challenges and issues regarding gender

So we start with **1 Timothy chapter 2** where we start at **verse 8** and read through verse **15**

We know that in the book of Timothy, Paul is writing to Timothy, who is pastoring a body of believers in Ephesus.

Our three topics above run through verses 8-15

- We've got an appeal to a creational pattern
- We've got gender in the church
- We've got contemporary challenges and issues regarding gender

First recognize that Paul articulates limitation on both genders:

A. We see that by the limitations he puts on men during verse 8. Verse 8 doesn't feel controversial though. It feels like good exaltation.
B. Verse 9 and follow seem to showcase the limitations on women. This does feel controversial for a variety of reasons.
C. We make intuitive sense of verses 9 and 10. We kinda get that. Peter writes the same during 1 Peter. But when we get to verses 11 through 15 that's a harder go.

Paul is prohibiting something. You can't say he's not prohibiting something. He's obviously prohibiting it with verses 11 and 12 but the question is what is he prohibiting? How are we to understand verse 11 -> "Let a woman learn quietly with all submissiveness." "I do not permit a woman to teach or to exercise authority over a man; rather, she is to remain quiet." **1 Timothy 2:11-12 ESV**.

How are we to understand the two verses above? We ask the same question of verse 15.

Verses 11 and 12 clearly offend modern sensibilities.

Verse 15 confuses -> "Yet she will be saved through childbearing—if they continue in faith and love and holiness, with self-control." **1 Timothy 2:15 ESV.** Saved from what? And why through child baring? What about women who aren't mothers?

Does quiet in verses 11 and 12 mean in complete silence? If someone would interpret it that way isn't Paul the one who writes instructing women during 1 Corinthians 11 to pray/prophecy? Both praying and prophecy are spoken realities.

Paul talks about women teaching other women in Titus. So what does silence mean?

Again what is being prohibited here in our Timothy passage? This isn't THEE answer but here's an angle. What's being prohibited here in our Timothy passage we have to draw the entire Timothy book into perspective to provide the angle that what's being discussed here is a particular kind of teaching authority that belongs to elders.

Some traditions will also refer to elders as pastors but Dr. Huffman states that pastors/pastoring is technically a gift that we've made an office when in reality the only two offices of the church, within the confines of the New Testament, are elders and deacons.

But Elders/pastors **1 Timothy 3** goes into the requirements for an elder. The one who is invested with teaching authority in the church when you trace this to the new testament.

Again there are places within Paul's writings where women are encouraged to speak. Encouraged to teach aka **Titus Chapter 2**. And teaching is a spiritual gift in addition to it being a cultivated skill. So when you look at spiritual gifts within the new testament it doesn't appear that gifts are gendered but offices are. Meaning women have teaching gifts. Women have leadership gifts. Leadership is a gift according to **Romans 12.** What women don't have is the calling to be elders. That's the line here. If we are just reading this at a face value of, "What is he talking about?" That seems to be what he is talking about with the Timothy context and the context of the pastoral apostles.

Timothy himself - when we see Paul speak during 2 Timothy chapter 1 - "you've known the scriptures from your infancy and who taught you? Your mother and your grandmother taught you." Paul honors these two women.

Aquila and Priscilla were a married couple from the church in Ephesus, originally from Rome (Acts 18:2). They first appear in Acts 18, where they meet Paul in Corinth and join him in ministry. Like Paul, they were tentmakers by trade and supported themselves while serving God. Together, they taught Apollos, a gifted evangelist, "the way of God more accurately" (Acts 18:26), with both husband and wife actively involved in his instruction. They were part of the Ephesian church under Timothy's oversight and played a key role in discipleship and teaching. And it wasn't mistaken for Aquila and Priscilla to do that so again what's going on here in 1 Timothy 2?

To answer that question let's start with **verses 11 and 12.**

Some people will say that what Paul is saying is you kind of have to know the ephesian context Artemis worship was big there. Dr. Huffman then says, " Just like it is in Nashville, TN because they have the Parthenon as part of Centennial Park," which he says is Artemis's temple.

Ephesus was indeed the center of the **Artemis (Greek) or Diana (Roman) cult**, which was one of the most prominent female-led religious movements in the ancient world. Artemis was worshiped as a mother and fertility goddess, and women played a central role in the temple and its rituals.

Some scholars propose that **Paul's instruction for women to learn quietly and not to exercise authority over men (1 Tim 2:12)** is, at least in part, **addressing this specific context**: certain women in Ephesus were promoting **false teaching or heretical ideas**, possibly influenced by or resembling the practices of Artemis worship. Paul's command may therefore be **both doctrinal and practical**, aiming to protect the church from teachings that were contrary to the gospel and to maintain order in the worship and instruction of the local congregation.

It's also consistent with the broader context of 1 Timothy, where Paul warns against **false teachers and disruptive behavior** (1 Tim 1:3–7, 6:3–5). The silence is not a general statement about women's learning or teaching in every context, but rather **directed at a specific problem in Ephesus at that time**.

This is an interpretation that gets offered because if we go back to chapter 1 verse 3 Paul says to Timothy -> "As I urged you when I was going to Macedonia, remain at Ephesus so that you may charge certain persons not to teach any different doctrine,"

1 Timothy 1:3 ESV

Verse 3 is Timothy's marching orders ->from Paul. The church in Ephesus already exists. Timothy is not planting the Church. He's pastoring it. Timothy is there to charge certain people with not teaching different doctrine. So some scholars come along and go "ah since this false Artemis cult is big and this deification of women is big within Ephesus context Paul's statements in chapter 2:8-15 must be about that. The "certain persons" we see within verse 3 is referring to certain women in Ephesus who are emboldened by the Artemis cult which was large there and because of that certain women were teaching different doctrine and Paul is telling them specifically to be silent during 1 Timothy 2:12.

Would it were that easy - says Dr. Huffman. He then goes on to say " if that were the case you wouldn't want those women teaching women either. Not just men and verse 12 specifies the teaching of men.

Dr. Huffman then goes on to point out that the Greek construction, in English, is rendered in most English translations during 1 Timothy 2:12 as " "I do not permit a woman to teach or to exercise authority over a man; rather, she is to remain quiet."

The construction of that in Greek is where you almost hyphenate it. "I do not permit a woman to exercise teaching authority over a man." Why not? Because they can't teach? No, we know that's not true. Because they don't have teaching gifts? No. Because women are ignorant? No. Because women are….. NO. Because women's calling is to not be an elder. Elders are a gendered role as seen by Chapter 3 where it's specified and says, " An elder must be above approach the Husband of one wife." It's specified .

The related idea of "teaching authority" is the issue here and the calling is on elders to conduct and oversee the teaching of the church. That's what's going on.

Here in 1 Timothy 2 Paul argues on the creation order with verses 13 and 14 -> "For Adam was formed first, then Eve; and Adam was not deceived, but the woman was deceived and became a transgressor."

He's again thinking back to Genesis 3. Back to the fall.

Before we dive into that point the church gets called in 1 Timothy Chapter 3 during verse 15 -> "if I delay, you may know how one ought to behave in the household of God, which is the church of the living God, a pillar and buttress of the truth."

Note how he calls the Church the household of God. In Paul's writings he talks about households. He calls the church the household of God but he also gives instructions to fathers, husbands, mothers, wives in spots like Ephesians 5, Colossians 3, Ephesians 6 there's a lot of places where Paul says, " Here's how the christian household, the family, should conduct itself."

And so Paul calling the church the household of God here is worth noting because Paul then applies those household codes to these church texts in speaking to men and women as he does during chapter 2 8:15 he is as it were speaking to the fathers and the mothers of the church. Not the parent sense of fathers and mothers but the leader's sense of fathers and mothers. And he's saying, "Here's the way I want the order of the church to be when you gather."

Elders, as introduced in 1 Timothy chapter 3, are essentially the fathers of the church in a leadership sense. When we examine New Testament history, it appears that elders were exclusively male, which supports the view that this is a gendered role. Yet, leadership in the New Testament also includes qualities that appeal to both genders. For example, in 1 Thessalonians 2, Paul reflects on his ministry alongside Silas and Timothy among the Thessalonians, saying that they were “gentle among you, like a nursing mother, and like a father we exhorted you.” Even in a classic leadership text, Paul demonstrates that effective ministry models both nurturing care and authoritative guidance, showing that authentic leadership can embody traits associated with both genders.

To dive further as mothers (from the leadership sense) who were within Ephesus church Chapter 5 of 1 Timothy talks about widows. Why?

What’s the protocol if a widow who is talked about in chapter 5 hosts a church within her own home? Where because she’s a widow who is the head of household now? Her. The household she’s managing -> “So I would have younger widows marry, bear children, manage their households, and give the adversary no occasion for slander.” **1 Timothy 5:14 ESV.** It’s fascinating that here Paul would tell the younger widows to manage their households because what does he say of elders in chapter 3 verse 4 -> “He must manage his own household well, with all dignity keeping his children submissive,” **1 Timothy 3:4 ESV.** We see him using the same word. Elders manage their household and manage the household of God. Widows manage their own household as well. So since it’s the same wording what does that mean?

There would be cases where the churches met in the homes of widowed women. This is affirmed. The church back then existed typically in homes. Later on, as the church grew it would become a city center and a place you would meet. But before that you’ve got churches as homes where communion would take place within this echo system of house churches and these are homes that are managed by widows and so again Paul’s instruction is even in their own home that they are managing - an elder is to do the teaching. That’s to whom the teaching authority of the church is entrusted.

Carrying that integrity. Protecting the doctrine integrity of the church. The teaching authority of the church is entrusted to elders and that appears, by all accounts, a gendered male office.

Again spiritual gifts don’t appear to be gendered but the spiritual function of the elder office is because it includes teaching authority. And when Paul makes an appeal as to

why that is he goes back to creation order. He says headship is baked in. It's there before the fall and states that it was intentional. Adam was made first and then eve.

All of that to say " here's how to read verse 12. " -> "I do not permit a woman to teach or to exercise authority over a man; rather, she is to remain quiet." **1 Timothy 2:12 ESV**

The best way to understand, teach or exercise authority as it says in English is that this is actually a combined idea. Hyphenate it. "Teaching-Authority." The elders are tasked with that and the Elders are gendered male. They are tasked with guarding the doctrine.

Now Dr. Huffman says let's step back and he will give us "two pairs of eye glasses." Eye glasses that we should put on when we read a gendered passage like this one in 1 Timothy particularly as 21st century moderns. He then continues the analogy "both pairs of eye glasses, since eye glasses have two sides allow us to keep two things before us at once. Both pairs of eye glasses he wants to give us will try to account for the creational pattern and the contemporary challenges and issues. One pair we will call gender and culture. The other set of eye glasses will be called posture and gestures."

First gender and culture biblically considered when you take the whole of scripture the major difference between a biblical world view and a modern world view is that in the scriptures gender is fixed. In the modern freeflowing kind of debate that we are having as a culture gender is fluid.

Biblically speaking gender is fixed on fluid. Culture is fluid, not fixed. Cultures come and go. Civilizations rise and fall. The bible has outlasted all of them.

The bible presents itself as transcultural (meaning that the Bible's core message goes beyond, rises above, and is not bound to any single culture, time period, or social system) in its core messaging.

It was written in and to certain cultures which are now ancient to us but they were contemporary at the time - meaning "with the times." So first century culture was at one point contemporary. What was written in the scriptures transcends cultures. To speak to various cultures. Oh course there were cultural things in scripture like head coverings that Dr. Huffman says we will get to when dissecting 1 Corinthians 11. A cultural expression of a creation principle.

Now let's take this modern Western culture idea that getting purchased right now that gender is socially constructed.

Dr. Huffman then references an NPR Saturday morning quiz show called, *Wait Wait… Don't Tell Me!* The guest that day was Judith Butler—one of the main individuals responsible for the idea that "gender is socially fluid." She's a gender studies scholar who believes gender is changeable and socially constructed. The host of *Wait Wait… Don't Tell Me!* is a guy named **Peter Sagal**. Peter says to Judith, "Wasn't it great to see Sydney Sweeney's character in *White Lotus* reading your book?" Judith responds with, "Yeah, I was really flattered by that." But then she kind of joked, "You know Sydney Sweeney's character in *White Lotus* is kind of a mean girl, and I'm not really for that."

To which Dr. Huffman thought, "Isn't it interesting that you, Judith Butler, are encouraging us to consider a fluid social construction, but you can't be a mean girl? Why is that the set thing? Why is the gender you're born with changeable, but even when people try to argue coloring outside the lines of where the Scriptures draw them, they still draw with Christian markers."

Scripture of course does not teach that gender is socially constructed. Scripture teaches that our gender is core to who we are as human beings. It's sacred.

Let me compare ethnicity and gender to you for a moment. Follow this argument.

If ethnicity is sacred then racism in practice desacralizes ethnicity because it makes superficial skin deep differences fundamental. Somehow I'm a totally different human being than you simply because I'm a different color. Which is false. Therefore racism is rightfully called sin because it makes a superficial distinction fundamental.

If gender is also sacred then LGBT in practice desacralizes gender because it makes fundamental distinctions superficial.

We live in a cultural context where many now recognize the sacredness of race and ethnicity but desacralize gender to accommodate LGBT. It doesn't work. It's a fundamental hypocrisy.

Now when we go back to 1 Timothy Chapter 2:13 we go back to analyzing the generational pattern. Adam first and then Eve. Again before sin you have a pattern of Adam first and then Eve. The bible speaks to gender transculturally and the way it does is that it goes back to creation order.

Now we break down the second set of eye glasses - posture and gestures.

Postures are unconscious default positions that we keep. It's your reactions. You don't know why you just do.

Gestures are how we convey those postures often reactively.

Speaking of gender Dr. Huffman has heard people say " if you keep to the Genesis gender roles then you're a chauvinist who dishonors women and he's heard **Complementarianism Gender apartheid (term used to describe systems or practices in which people are systematically segregated, restricted, or denied rights based on gender). And if you think the bible teaches gender roles maleheadship you probably think slavery is okay too.**

Dr. Huffman then goes on to quote an article from a female he read one time to which the writer said, " she could never listen to people with a complementarianism belief system talk about justice because their gender ideology was fundamentally unjust."

Dr Huffman says that's not a good way to reason. That's reactive. It's not reflective. It doesn't think. It doesn't cast the other view in the best possible light. You should not want to react to strawmen. On the flipside Dr. Huffman has heard that if you posture and gesture the elder office is open to women then you're dishonoring the bible. Or if you don't think the bible teaches gender roles then you probably go soft on biblical sexual ethics as it pertains to LGBT. You may have anecdotal evidence for someone doing that but labeling like that, projecting like that, pidgin holing is usually an emotional reaction. It doesn't come out of reflection.

Every culture has a narrative it's trying to live out which is why the bible is transcultural. It has its own narrative. God always rises above and outlives the errors of His people.

When it comes to gender, the gospel confronts the idea that gender is a social construction self creation.

The gospel completes gender by offering full equal redemption for both sexes.

The gospel offers gender completion not through marriage but through redemption. That you get to be, the collective, the bride of Christ. That's what completes us.

Verse 13-14 -> We know that 1 Timothy 2:14 is not Paul teaching that men are superior and women are inferior. He points to role reversal to make a different point. First, he observes that Adam was created first and Eve second. Then, in verse 14, he notes that Eve sinned first and Adam second. In one category, men are "first," and in another, women are "first." This demonstrates a sort of even playing field, not in terms of who can serve in leadership roles in the church, but in terms of spiritual gifts, leadership, and relational responsibility.

Dr. Huffman's mother writes in her book: regarding 1 Timothy 2:13–14, for years she thought the text suggested that women were less capable than men. Later, she realized that's not the point. There is no real "winner" in the narrative of the fall: both Eve and Adam's choices contributed to it. Eve was deceived and acted out of ignorance; Adam acted deliberately, yet both led to the same outcome.

In Genesis we witness Satan doing what? -> He goes after God's order and inverts it. Turning it on its head. Why does Satan attack that? Because he knows creation order matters.

How does the gospel console gender? Dr. Huffman believes it's located here in **Verse 15 despite that it's one of the most challenging verses in the new testament to understand.**

"Yet she will be saved through childbearing—if they continue in faith and love and holiness, with self-control." **1 Timothy 2:15 ESV**

The understanding Dr. Huffman is going to pick from Alistair Roberts who is a theologian and author who has been affiliated with Theopolis Institute.

He points out here that contextually because you've got Adam and Eve in verses 13 and 14 - verses 13 is Genesis 1 and 2. Verse 14 - is Genesis 3. Alister says in this context we have a broad reference to Genesis 1-3 and the way verse 15 is phrased seems to be a comprehensive statement that follows through on the logic of creation, the fall, the narrative of promise and redemption and restoration that begins in Genesis and moves through the rest of the biblical narrative because within the context of the fall what is emphasized when it comes to the women post fall? Childbearing aka Genesis 3.

As Genesis goes on:

Sarah struggles with Child birth

Rebecca struggles

Rachel does

This is the key note of unfolding the biblical drama of salvation.

The story of exodus begins with childbirth struggles

The story of the kingdom in Samuel begins with Hannah struggling to have a child.

The prophets frame the story of redemption as Israel struggling to bring forth her children. All the way up to the story of the Gospel with Mary a virgin. And Elizabeth, someone who had not before been able to carry prior to the birth of John.

So what Paul seems to be saying within Childbaring is he's using it as a clue, a key, a reference point to the salvation narrative of scripture. One one had you understand the difference between male and female established at the beginning but you also seem to understand that the very thing that seems to marginalize women actually gives them central stage at the most critical moments of biblical history. Deliverance, promise, salvation, redemption comes through key births. If that's the guiding story then women have, in the congregation, provenance, respect, and honor within the life of the congregation even if they aren't the intended guardians of the church. If we understand the shape of salvation history how key women are to that history. You won't have a domineering culture in your church. You can't have one.

Intro to Manhood/Womanhood Part 2 Dr. Cole Huffman:

Dr. Huffman starts off by saying we are moving onto 1 Corinthians 11.

He states that gender is something we think of as physical but there is also a spiritual dimension to it.

Dr. Huffman refers to the **heretical *Gospel of Thomas***, a non-canonical text. In **Logion 114**, the text falsely records Jesus saying that he will make a particular woman (Mary) "male" so that she may enter the kingdom. Dr. Huffman notes that he has encountered men who think this way—but **Jesus never said this**.

This saying does **not** appear anywhere in the canonical Gospels and reflects **Gnostic theology**, not biblical Christianity. Gnosticism often viewed the physical world—and particularly the female body—as inferior, teaching that salvation required transcending material existence. That worldview is fundamentally opposed to Scripture.

Biblically, men and women are **equally created in the image of God** (Genesis 1:27), **equally fallen**, and **equally redeemed** in Christ (Galatians 3:28). Jesus consistently affirms the dignity and spiritual agency of women, teaches them as disciples, and entrusts them with proclamation—most notably as the first witnesses of the resurrection. At no point does Jesus suggest that women must become men to enter the kingdom.

Therefore, any theology that implies women must become “male” to be fully included in God’s kingdom is **explicitly unbiblical** and reflects **Gnostic distortion**, not the teaching of Jesus or the apostles.

If you want to boil manhood and womanhood down to a singular verse Dr. Huffman asserts verse 11 is that. “Nevertheless, in the Lord woman is not independent of man nor man of woman;” **1 Corinthians 11:11 ESV**

The Bible’s teaching on male and female embodiedness is that we need each other to be fully human.

Verse 11 states that not only are we not independent of one another but we also aren’t interchangeable.

As we dive into 1 Corinthians 11 **we want to be looking for the same three topics** we were with 1 Timothy:

1. **Gender at creation**
2. **Is there a creational pattern?**
3. **Contemporary challenges and issues regarding gender**

Dr. Huffman says people will point to the head covering portion of chapter 11 and say, “ see the bible is regressive.”

Most evangelically minded teachers will address head coverings in this way, “ The reason why this instruction, on head coverings was given specifically, to the Corinthians was because this was a church riven with division. It was a large church as far as ancient churches went and had a diverse mix of rich and poor. Corinth was a very have and have not city. Some of the women had long hair which was, in Greek culture, typically a sign of wealth and privilege. That you could care for long hair. You could have long hair because you weren’t working. It wasn’t in the way of things that other women were doing. Some women sold their hair due to need. Some, it’s often suggested (despite the fact that Dr. Huffman says there is a problem with this suggestion) some say that in temple prostitution there is evidence that women would shave their heads as they engaged in pagan temple prostitution. But Dr. Huffman says that’s disputed because there is archeological evidence that presents prostitutes with hair. Adding further complexity, a common punishment for an adulterous woman, within this context and culture, was to shave her head to publicly shame her. Which Paul seems to have in mind.

So we can say the head covering matter is given within the wider context of addressing church divisions.

How do you address church divisions? You have to appeal to the basis of unity. When you appeal to that unity you are also appealing to authority. Women rich and poor, hair and no hair, gathering for worship, if they are all wearing head coverings it symbolizes unity in Christ and equal status under Christ authority. A cultural expression dresses cultural for a larger point. The point is creational

Later on in Chapter 14 of 1 Corinthians Paul says all things within the church should be done for building up. All things should be done with decency and order (14:4). One of Paul's templates for order is creation order. So when Paul calls the church to order one of those ways that fleshes out is creation order. The way God designed men and women to act before the fall. So after the fall yes there is tension. There is friction. There's incomprehensibility to one another but that's why the new testament writers like Paul keep coming back to something like this. If anyone in Corinth would say they don't want to do the head coverings then Paul would respond, " Then you're not keeping with the implication and application of creation order."

Dr. Huffman says the expression informing the principle is the key thing. Not the expression itself. Dr. Huffman says he's heard people dismiss creation order as an outdated way to argue. Except why does Paul keep going to the prefall arrangement. He does it all over the place. It's his go to.

So Dr. Huffman asks if head coverings should still be a thing? Dr. Huffman believes that answer is no. He reads the text as head covering are just a cultural expression of a creation principle.

There are several submission lines in the bible that talk about areas women should submit to men but there is no submission line that says all women should submit to all men. There is a submission line that says we should submit to one another out of reverence for Christ.

An idea can not be held responsible for those who claim to believe it. An idea might still be good even if the people that hold to it misapply it or are terrible examples of it. If people associate your view with being harsh or ridged you have relational problems.

Dr. Huffman, as a complimentarian, does believe that complimentarians tend to overthink this subject.

The fault of complimentarians is that we tend to overthink this subject in trying to account for every possible leadership and teaching scenario we could possibly think of in the church - Dr. Huffman

“Can a woman teach four year old little boys? Yeah she can” - Dr. Huffman.

“The people outside of your viewpoint often have the best angle for critiquing where your viewpoint is off.” Aka sometimes you need to listen to your critiques.

Dr. Huffman acknowledges there is a condition for gender dysphoria. He says we would expect that in a fallen world with fallen genetics. But transgenderism as it’s often practiced a lot of Christians will offer a siege mentality when they see that. Christians really should be neither. They shouldn’t be accommodationist or to say we are going to be defined by “not accepting that.” We are people of conviction but shouldn’t be either an accommodationist nor backlashers. If you want to nativate this culture biblically, as confused as it is, we have to learn to do two things at once. 1. Affirm the human design of God as true, good, and beautiful. God doesn’t make any junk and 2. Not to treat the person in front of us, who is out of step with God’s design, as a battlefield.

He goes on to say, “you can be the laziest person on earth and denounce. It takes no work to dismiss and demean. It takes work to do two things at once because understanding and loving through disapproving takes work and you will risk being misunderstood and misconstrued.”

Manhood / Womanhood Part 2 Donna Gaines:

Developing Female Leaders by Kad. Cole is a good resource Donna Gaines says for understanding the complementarian and egalitarian mindsets.

1 Corinthians 13 says that real love doesn't take into account a wrong suffered.

Marriage biblically defined goes back to creation. Genesis 2:24

If you look at Ephesians 5 the commands given to a woman and the commands given to a man the man is given almost twice the number of words that the woman is given because he has the greater responsibility.

Malachi 2:14 -> "But you say, "Why does he not?" Because the Lord was witness between you and the wife of your youth, to whom you have been faithless, though she is your companion and your wife by covenant."

When we look at **Ephesians 5** If we go from **verse 22 through the end of verse 24** there are **57 English words** referring to the wives instruction.

From **verse 25 through verse 31 we see the man's instruction receives 126 English words.**

As a woman, Jesus Christ meets your basic needs for love and significance. These are the basic needs of all human beings, something both Christian and secular psychologists would agree on. We all want to feel loved. We all want our lives to matter—to have purpose and significance.

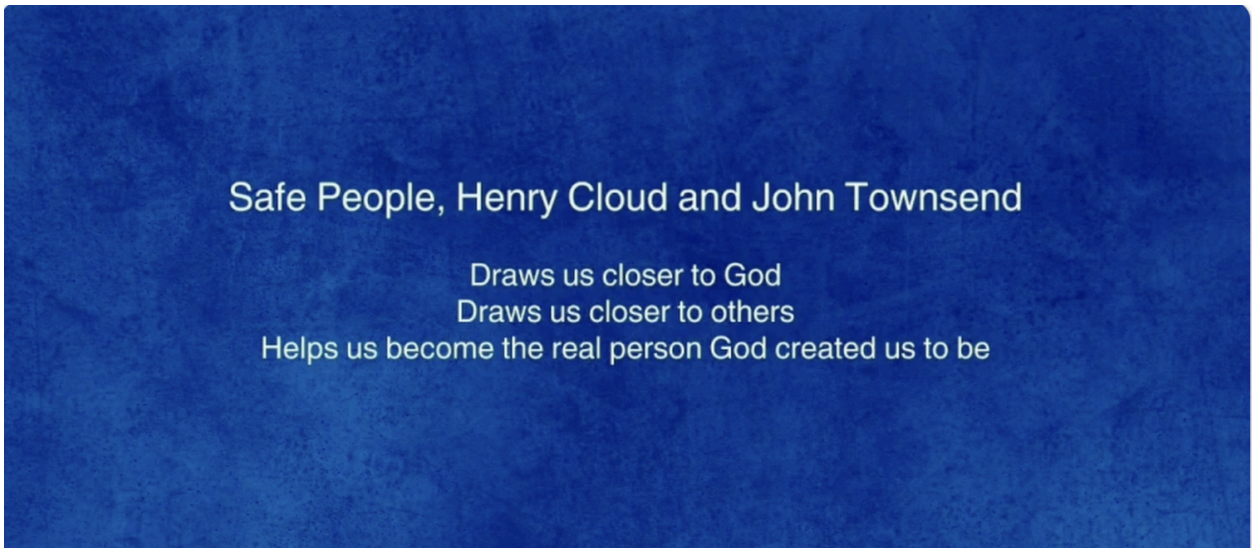
It is only in Christ, at every moment, that you are genuinely loved and eternally significant, where your deepest needs are met through your personal relationship with Jesus Christ. From that place, you are able to love your husband, your children, your extended family, your friends, and your coworkers out of the overflow.

You are not a beggar walking around with an empty cup, needing someone else to fill it. They were never designed to fill the hole in your heart. That hole can only be filled by Jesus Christ.

***The Meaning of Marriage* by Timothy Keller ->** With the gospel, marriage is meant to reflect the relationship Christ has with the Church, His bride. If God had the gospel of Jesus—salvation— in mind when He established marriage, then marriage only works to the degree that it approximates the pattern of God's self-giving love in Christ.

Start here: ask what Christ has done for you in Jesus, and then live that out for your spouse. When that foundation is in place, the rest will follow.

This is the secret—that the gospel of Jesus and marriage explain one another. When God invented marriage, He already had the saving work of Jesus in mind.



Deuteronomy 6 your children *